

Documentation software



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What is Software Documentation?

Software documentation is a long procedure to keep your software project on track.

Once you are done with [software development](#), you already know **how each element works** and have already **memorized or made notes of key functions and capabilities**, thus finding the process of documentation unnecessary.

However, without documentation, your software is like a **black box**.

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A **black box**, in terms of software, *can be defined as an object or a system whose inner workings, designs or implementations are hidden from the **outside world**.*

Let's first go through the guidelines you need to follow for the documentation and learn how it will benefit you.

Guidelines to follow through

1. Reader's View: Documentation should be **not open to more than one interpretation**. This makes the reader understand the documentation and work on it better.

2. Unambiguous: Documentation should be unambiguous, clear, precise, and to the point.

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3. Repetition: Documentation should not include any repetition. It should be **brief**.

4. Updated: Avoid having **pending things** be added to the document. Your documentation should be up to date with the recent changes.

Documents that are **outdated should be removed after finalizing all added content parts**. This will just keep the final document consisting of all required information.

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Advantages of software documentation

- 1. Tracking:** The main objective of documentation is to keep track of all parts of a software project.
- 2. Maintenance:** While you have documentation, the maintenance of the project is easier.
- 3. Understanding:** Documentation makes it easier for learners or programmers other than the developers to understand the codes and working of the software.
- 4. Quality:** Documentation obviously improves the quality of the software.

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5. Assistance: The documentation process assists users during user training.

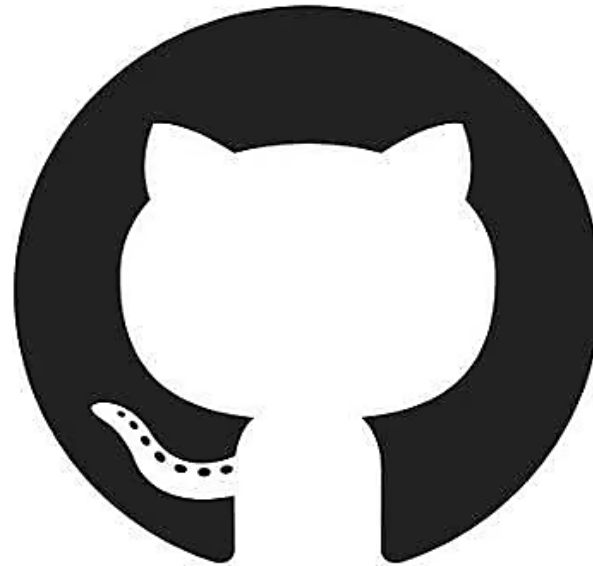
6. Knowledge sharing: Since everything is documented, it ensures knowledge being shared and understood by everyone. Anyone can read the documentation and easily track all the work and usage of code snippets at different parts of the software. This will cut down costs and efforts made in training new people if someone leaves the organization.

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Best online software documentation tools in the market

Here's a list of the most trusted software documentation tools available in the market:

1. GitHub



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2. Docz



3. Read the Docs

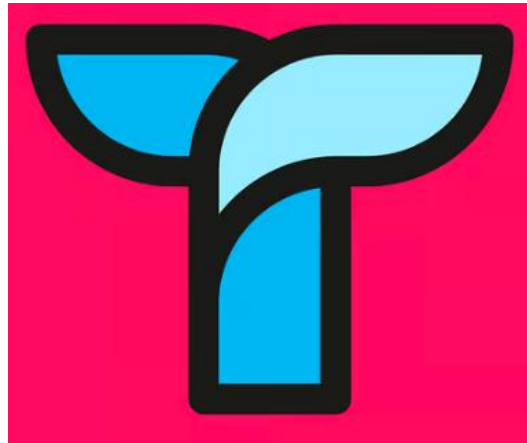


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4. Bit.ai



5. Tettra



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6. MarkdownPad



7. Doxygen



thank
you!

The text 'thank you!' is written in a black, cursive script. The word 'thank' is on the top line and 'you!' is on the bottom line. A long, thick black swoosh underline is positioned under the 'thank' line. The entire text is surrounded by numerous small, four-pointed gold stars of varying sizes. The background is plain white.